

What is Anthropology?

↙ across time + space

- Study humans from comparative perspective

- Primarily interested in culture

↗ our values/beliefs

- learned

- give meaning to our behavior

- makes us unique as a species

"What does it mean to be human?"

Our distinctly complex development of culture

- one way humans adapt to new environments

Four Field Discipline

- **Socio-cultural**: compares living humans + cultures/politics

- **Linguistics**: evolution of language

- **Archaeology**: material remains of past/extinct populations (more recent = disaster archaeology)

- **Biological**: science of human life; evolution

- ↳ **Human biology**: genetics, behavior, growth, physical/cultural adaptation

- ↳ **Primatology**: non human living primates (closest to humans)

- ↳ **Paleoanthropology**: evolution of anatomy/behavior

- ↳ **Skeletal biology**: examining bones of past populations (aka bioarchaeology)